



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Can you hear me? Is there something wrong with the connection?



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you own a cell phone? What brand is it?
- Have you ever had problems with your phone? What kind?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technical problems and solutions.
- I can respond politely to suggestions.
- I can say what people are doing now or in the future.





Let's Explore!

Peter is having **technical*** issues with his phone!

* "Technical" means requiring special knowledge to be understood.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Peter: I'm nervous about calling Tracy. I'd better wait till later.
Robert: You're asking her out again, right? You should just call. You'll do great! You ought to do it right now!
Peter: Yeah, I know. OK. Here goes. I don't believe it! My phone isn't working!
Robert: You'd better call the phone company. Here, use my phone.
Peter: You're right. Thanks.
Telephone Technician: Hello, City Phones. How can I help you?
Peter: I can't get a connection on my phone. All I hear is crackling. There's only interference.
Telephone Technician: You should try turning your phone off, then on again.
Peter: OK. I've done that. Can you do anything at your end?
Telephone Technician: OK, I'm going to check the connection from here. I'll just troubleshoot your line.
Peter: Oh! That worked! Thank you!
Telephone Technician: I'm glad to help. Can I do anything else for you?
Peter: No thanks. I appreciate your help. Bye. I'll call Tracy right now before it dies again!
Robert: Good idea.
Peter: Uh, hi Tracy? It's Peter Smith. I'm calling to see if you want to go out this weekend.



Let's Practice!

Will Peter call Tracy?

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. I'm nervous about
2. You're asking her
3. You'll do
4. Here, use
5. OK, I'm going to check
6. I'll just troubleshoot
7. I'm calling to see if you

COLUMN B

- a. want to go out this weekend.
- b. the connection from here.
- c. out again, right?
- d. great!
- e. your line.
- f. my phone.
- g. calling Tracy.



Let's Practice!

Peter needs help with his phone!

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word bank

interference / connection / crackling / working / troubleshoot

1. My phone isn't_____!
2. I can't get a_____on my phone.
3. All I hear is a_____, snapping noise.
4. There's only_____.
5. I'll just_____your line from here.





Extension Activity

Write questions about technical issues.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of five technical problems you could have with your computer or phone.
- Write a set of questions to ask the technician.
- Write solutions to the problems beside the questions.
- Read your questions aloud.
- Practice them until they sound natural.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I prepare questions related to technical problems.

☐ ☐

I write questions about the problems.

☐ ☐

I write solutions.

☐ ☐

I practice my questions aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- connection** (noun): something that joins or connects two or more things
e.g. During the storm, they lost their phone connection.
- interference** (noun): signals that weaken or block a phone conversation
e.g. There was too much interference on the phone to hear what she was saying.
- crackling** (adjective): making snapping sounds
e.g. All I heard on my phone was crackling.
- to troubleshoot** (verb): to find out why something isn't working correctly
e.g. I can try troubleshooting from here.
- at your end** (expression): from your side
e.g. Can you do anything at your end?





Learning Points

Describing and Solving a Technical Problem

When you have a problem with your cell phone you call the company for help. You ask them to help you find a solution to the problem.

Describing a Problem	Solving a Problem
It seems to ...	Try resetting the ...
I'm having problems ...	Did you try ... ?
The screen always ...	Try ...
Whenever I use the ...	I suggest ...

Examples:

• **George:** *My phone isn't working.*

Phone Agent: *Have you tried turning it on and off?*

• **George:** *Whenever I use my phone I hear crackling.*

Phone Agent: *I suggest you bring the phone in.*

Responding Politely to Suggestions

When you are given a suggestion, you should always respond in a **polite** way.

Suggestion	Polite Response
<i>You should try turning your phone off then on again.</i>	<i>OK. I've done that.</i>
<i>You ought to do that right now!</i>	<i>Yeah, I know.</i>
<i>You'd better call the phone company.</i>	<i>You're right.</i>

Examples:

• **James:** *You ought to call her right now!*

Andrew: *Yeah, I know.*

• **James:** *You ought to call her this afternoon.*

Andrew: *You're right. I should.*

